

Alexander John Noles

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Personal profile

I am an enthusiastic and artistic, young game developer, seeking an entry level position in the game development industry that I can convert into a long-term career. I have experience in all parts of game development, from coding to sound design but especially with C# and Unity. In 2022, during my gap year, I released a solo project, called “Dash and Slash”, on the Steam Store. I went out of my way, during development of “Dash and Slash”, to create everything myself (including music, sound effects and art).

During my final year of university, I focused my dissertation on emergent narratives and how gameplay influences storytelling. Accordingly, I created a prototype of a simulation-driven RTS game, that borrowed heavily in style from games such as Kenshi and Stellaris. There is a large focus placed on the code side structure of simulations, in particular how to keep them flexible and expandable.

Most of my hobby and university work is stored on my Github, including my dissertation. A guide to its content can be found at the bottom of my portfolio.

Technical Skills

- C#
- Java
- Python
- Git and Github
- HTML
- JavaScript
- WHILE Language
- CSS
- Vue.js
- SQL
- HLSL
- Aseprite
- Blender
- Lab Chirp
- Unity (Primary version used is 2022.3.X)
- Godot
- Visual Studio
- Amazon Web Services (AWS)
- Jira
- Microsoft Office
- LaTeX

Degree

2022–2025: BSc (Hons) Computer Science, University of Sussex

Key modules include:

- Software Engineering
A group project module focused on recreating the board game RISK digitally. Allowed me to readily apply my game development knowledge in an academic setting.
- Further Programming
A first year module that focused on the organization of programs and general principles of good software design.
- Program Analysis
Enhanced my skill set in understanding the cost of programs and how to properly compare the quality of programs in a practical environment.
- Limits of Computation
Taught me the limits of computation, with a focus on specific undecidable programs and methods for proving decidability.

- **Web 3D Applications**
A practical focused module, centred around creating a 3D model showcase website. Allowed me to further practice my modelling skills, gaining further confidence in them.
 - **Compilers And Computer Architecture**
Focusing on the very fundamentals of how computers worked. The module helped solidify a proper foundation for all the rest of my knowledge, contextualizing it.
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Other Game Development Interests

- **Game Jams:**
Timed game making competitions, that can vary greatly in scale and target genre, they almost always have a theme. So far, I have taken part in 16 and submitted to 12, typically in a small team. My gap year project was originally one of these submissions.
- **Pixel-Art:**
I started doing Pixel-Art in 2019 as part of my very first game jam. Since then, I have used and improved my skills in many projects, including my released video game, “Dash and Slash”.
- **Shader coding:**
I made a concerted effort to improve at visual work and technical artistry during my first year of university. This involved creating several smaller visual projects and coding a basic 3D renderer. I’ve utilized these skills continuously throughout my game development work since learning them.
- **3D Modelling:**
I’ve been using blender on and off for 7+ years, utilizing it in a variety of game jams, my Final Year Project and of course my module “Web 3D Applications”. I began using blender more consistently about a year ago.

Additional Education

2014 – 2021 Farmors School

A Levels: Computer Science (A), Maths (B), Physics (C).

Received a certificate from my school for my effort and enthusiasm in Computer Science and Physics specifically.

GCSEs: 11 subjects, grades A – C, including Maths, English, Photography, Spanish and Computer Science

Work experience

March 2022 – September 2022: Shop Assistant, Londis

- Worked doing a variety of different things, from shelf stacking to cleaning.
- Developed effective communication skills to assist customers both while working on the tills and on the shop floor.
- Helped train newer shop assistants, in all aspects of the job.

January 2022 – July 2022: Solo game developer

- Worked alone, requiring me to learn effective time management.
- Filled a large range of roles, gaining experience in every aspect of game development, from the beginning of the process to release.

September 2021 – January 2022: Kitchen Porter, Jack’s Café and Restaurant

- Worked effectively in a high stress environment, alongside co-workers.
- Developed the skills to keep my workspace in good condition, including maintenance on cleaning equipment.
- Assisted the chefs/other staff members with their cleaning and preparation duties.
- Was forced to leave in early January due to a health condition caused by the hot and cramped environment.

2018: School Work experience, St James's Place

- Introduced to and helped with a variety of roles over the course of a week.
- Gained experience working in a proper workplace and learned how to better present myself.

Voluntary experience

Late 2019: Village clean up, Poulton

- Assisted with a community effort to remove litter from our village.

References available on request.